

progress as a whole. Most LMSs are web-based. A well-designed LMS should be able to provide complete help with administration and usually should be able to do the following without the need for instructor involvement:

- ▶ Student self-service including self-registration
- ▶ Purchasing the course
- ▶ Online test creation
- ▶ Automated notifications
- ▶ Collaborative learning spaces
- ▶ Assemble and deliver learning content rapidly

The term LMS though is often confused with CMS (course management system) and LCMS (Learning Content Management System). A Course Management System is usually used primarily for supporting the placement of course learning online and other similar functions as an LMS but doesn't have the administrative functions (user notifications, wait-list management, self-registration etc.) that an LMS has. An LCMS on the other hand typically provides a multi-user environment where administrators, instructors, and content managers can create, store, reuse, and manage learning



objects from a central object repository. So, rather than developing entire courses and adapting them to multiple audiences (like an LMS), an LCMS provides the ability for courses to be modified and republished while maintaining versions and history. And as

there is no industry standardization yet, there is confusion over which term is what – but usually, LMS is taken to be the ubiquitous term, even while referring to a CMS or an LCMS.

Now we know there are two things – the content and the system (LMS), the only thing that is missing is a standard that would ensure that these two can work and communicate with each other. Basically, there have to be some specifications that ensure that the course content 'plug' right into the LMS and function well together. That's where SCORM comes in. Sharable Content Object Reference Model (SCORM) specification is widely taken